

YANG, XUETING

Department of Economics and Related Studies, University of York, York, YO10 5DD

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Experimental and Behavioural Economics, with a focus on decision-making under risk and ambiguity, consumer behaviour, and applied microeconomic theory.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Microeconomics, Behavioural Economics, Experimental Economics

RESEARCH AGENDA

My research lies in experimental and behavioural economics, focusing on decision-making under risk and ambiguity. I develop a coherent research programme across three main streams:

- Probability misperception in consumer decision-making
- Complexity and cognitive constraints in ambiguous decision-making
- Applications of behavioural decision-making to labour contracts, insurance, and other policy-relevant settings

Going forward, I aim to develop these themes into a sustained research programme on how cognitive constraints and probability misperception shape economic decisions under uncertainty, while continuing to use experimental methods to test and compare competing theoretical models.

EDUCATION

09/2023 – 2027 (Expected) University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies York, UK

Ph.D., Economics

Dissertation: *Individual decision-making in ambiguous (and risky) situations*

Expected thesis submission: November 2026

09/2020 – 03/2022 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

MSc, Economics and Finance (with Distinction)

09/2015 – 07/2019 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

BSc, Economics and Finance (with British First-class Degree)

PUBLICATION

Yang, X., & Hey, J. (2025). **Do workers maximize expected utility when choosing labour contracts under ambiguity?** *Journal of Risk and Uncertainty*, 71(3), 273–292. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11166-025-09470-w>

JOB MARKET PAPER

- **“Less Is More”: Decision-Making under Increasingly Complex Ambiguity** (*Revision, Journal of Risk and Uncertainty*)

Examines whether increasingly complex decisions under ambiguity require more parameterized behavioural models. Using a laboratory allocation experiment and individual-level model comparison, the paper compares Expected Utility (EU), α MaxMin (AMM), and Choquet Expected Utility (CEU) across ambiguous choice environments of increasing structural complexity. EU is most frequently selected by AICc across all three ambiguous-lottery tasks, although its relative advantage varies across tasks and CEU remains competitive in the most complex setting.

WORKING PAPER

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- **Probability Misperception in Blind Box Consumption: An Experimental Investigation of Risk and Ambiguity Preferences** (*submitted*)
- Uses laboratory experiments (BDM mechanism) to test whether consumers overestimate low-probability outcomes. Results show systematic overestimation, particularly among risk-seeking individuals, suggesting that probability misperception may help explain demand for blind boxes.

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

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- 06/2026 *ASFEE 2026: Annual Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics*, Lille, France. (Oral Presentation)
 - 06/2026 *2026 CMID (conference on Mechanism and Institution Design)*, York, UK. (Member of local organization committee)
 - 06/2026 *FUR (Foundations of Utility and Risk) Conference 2026*, Alicante, Spain. (Oral Presentation)
 - 05/2026 *2026 Durham-Edinburgh-York Workshop*, Durham, UK. (Oral Presentation)
 - 03/2026 *ECO Department Brownbag Seminar*, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, Suzhou, China. (Presenter)
 - 10/2025 *Departmental Thursday Workshop*, University of York, York, UK. (Presenter)
 - 06/2025 *ASFEE 2025: 15th Conference of the French Experimental Economics Association*, Nancy, France. (Oral Presentation & Poster session)
 - 06/2025 *ESA 2025 World Meeting*, Beijing, China. (Oral Presentation)
 - 08/2024 *2024 SABE/IAREP Conference*, Dundee, UK. (Poster Session)

AWARDS & FUNDING

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- *Departmental PhD Studentship Funding*, University of York, 2023-2027
 - *2025-2026 Award for Outstanding Overseas Study Elite*, China Scholarship Council, 2026
 - *Teaching Excellence Award*, University of York, 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies	York, UK
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	
<i>Microeconomic Theory (Undergraduate)</i> , 09/2024 – 02/2026	
▪ Led tutorial sessions, explaining core microeconomic concepts and guiding students through problem-solving exercises ▪ Supported students in developing analytical and mathematical reasoning skills ▪ Provided detailed feedback on assignments and assessments	
<i>Probability and Statistics (Undergraduate)</i> , 02/2025 – 06/2025	
▪ Delivered small-group teaching sessions, assisting students in understanding probability theory and statistical methods ▪ Helped students apply theoretical concepts to practical problems	
Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou	Suzhou, China
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	

Experimental Economics and Finance (Undergraduate), 09/2021 – 12/2021

- Assisted in delivering experimental economics sessions, including supporting classroom experiments
- Facilitated student engagement and discussion in interactive learning environments
- Adapted teaching approach to support students with diverse academic backgrounds

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Student Development Advisor Center, Xi'an Jiaotong-liverpool University

Suzhou, China

Student Development Advisor (Full-time), 05/2022-05/2023

- Provided one-to-one guidance to students on personal, social, and campus-related challenges
- Supported student wellbeing and adjustment within an international university environment
- Handled urgent student issues and coordinated with relevant university services
- Organised and delivered student development activities and campus events
- Developed strong communication skills working with diverse student cohorts

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGE

Software & Programming

- **Experimental programming:** Visual Studio (C#/.NET), zTree; developed custom Windows Forms applications for risk/ambiguity elicitation, BDM mechanisms, and complexity treatments.
- **Quantitative analysis:** MATLAB, R, STATA; behavioural data analysis and econometric modelling.

Language Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic), Thai (beginner)

REFERENCES

Professor John Hey
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